

ER and EER diagrams, rendered

A test of the entity-relationship and enhanced-ER notation this manual will draw throughout Modules Two and Three. Every mark below is inline SVG, so it prints as crisply as the text.

1. The crow's-foot cardinality symbols

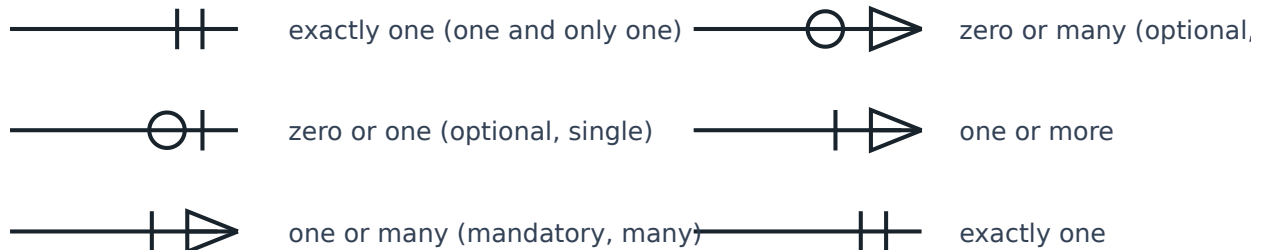


Figure A. The bar means "one", the circle means "optional (zero)", the crow's foot means "many". You read the marks at the end nearest the entity they constrain.

2. Entities, attributes, and a relationship

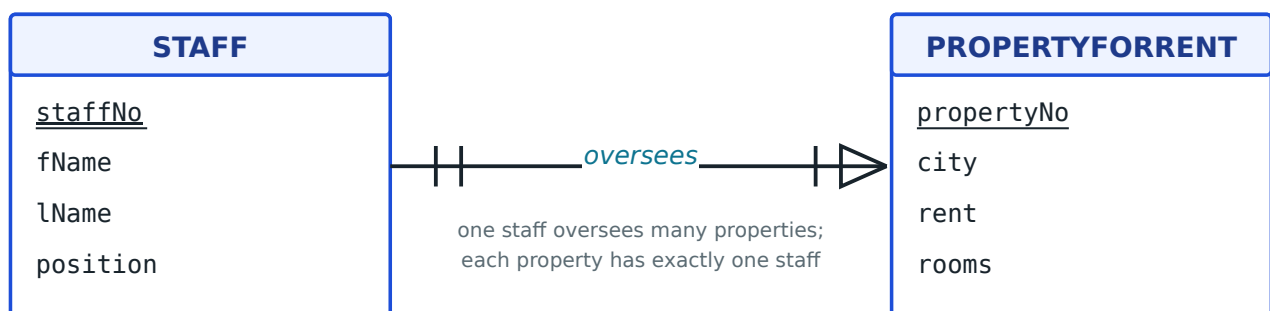


Figure B. Each entity is a box: name in the header, attributes below, the primary key underlined. The relationship reads "one STAFF oversees one-or-many PROPERTYFORRENT; each PROPERTYFORRENT is overseen by exactly one STAFF".

3. A many-to-many with an associative entity

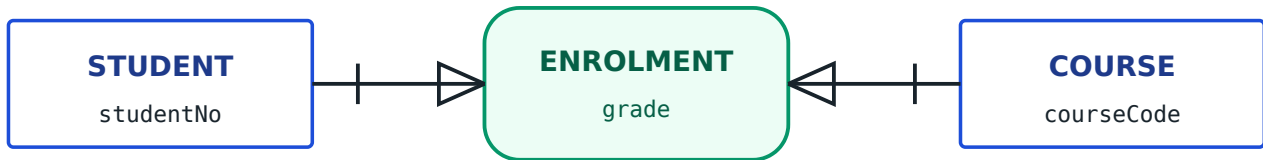


Figure C. A student takes many courses and a course has many students. That many-to-many is resolved by the associative entity *ENROLMENT* (rounded box), which holds the attribute that belongs to the pairing, the *grade*.

4. EER: supertype, subtypes, and the specialization rules

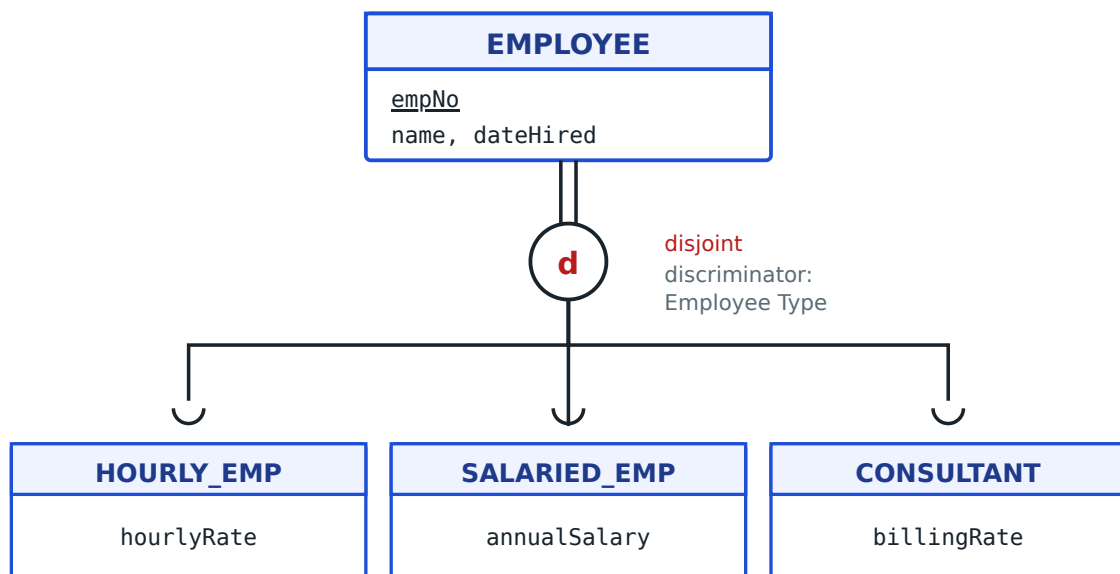


Figure D. *EMPLOYEE* is the supertype; the circle holds the disjoint rule ("d": an employee is at most one subtype) and names the discriminator. The double line into the circle means total specialization (every employee must be one of the three). The subset symbols point from each subtype up to the supertype it inherits from.